

Θεόπομπος ὁ Χῖος

Theopompus of Chios on History and Naval Preparations

eul_aid: fjg

Period: [Κλασική](#) [Classical](#)
Dialect: [Ἀττική](#) [Attic](#)
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Theopompus of Chios was a Greek historian and rhetorician of the 4th century BCE. Born around 378 BCE on Chios, he was exiled due to his father's pro-Spartan stance and studied in Athens under the orator Isocrates. Recalled to Chios by Alexander the Great around 333 BCE, he was exiled again after Alexander's death and spent his final years in Egypt at the court of Ptolemy I, dying after 320 BCE.

Ancient critics like Dionysius of Halicarnassus describe him as a moralizing, digressive, and sharply critical writer. His major works, surviving only in fragments, are historical. These include the *Hellenica*, a 12-book continuation of Thucydides covering the years 411 to 394 BCE, and the *Philippica*, a monumental 58-book history centered on Philip II of Macedon that included wide-ranging ethnographic digressions. He also composed rhetorical works, now lost, such as an *Epitome* of Herodotus.

Theopompus was a major historian, considered with Ephorus as one of Isocrates' two great pupils. His *Philippica* was ambitious in scope, framing Macedonian ascendancy within a broad geographical context. His method—combining extensive research with a strong, judgmental authorial voice—represents a significant development in Greek historiography between Thucydides and the Hellenistic era.

Works (3)

- [Ἀποσπάσματα περὶ Παρασκευῆς Ναυτικῆς](#) · [Fragments on Naval Preparations](#) · 3 passages
- [Ἀποσπάσματα](#) · [Historical Epitome Fragments](#) · 455 passages
- [Μαρτυρίαι](#) · [Testimonies](#) · 57 passages